



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

SEP 2018

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Good Things Happen
is the newsletter of
Minnehaha United Methodist Church,
published each month.

The deadline for October is
September 21

Contributions may be brought to the office
or emailed to:
office@minnehaha.org

Minneapolis, MN 55417
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About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

September



SUNDAY WORSHIP -FALL SCHEDULE BEGINS SEPT. 16

- 9:00 am Worship with organ and choir.
- 10:00 am Education & Fellowship
- 11:00 am Worship with band and vocals.

Minnehaha Happenings in September

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
						1 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
2 Communion 10a Worship with Organ 7p SAA	3 <i>Labor Day</i> 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts	4 Piano Tune 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters	5 10a Staff Meeting 5p Methodicals 7p Children's Council	6 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music (BMM) 2:30p BMM	7 10a Al-Anon 10:30a Brighter Minds 6:30p RCA 7p Movie: Harry Potter and the Sorcerer's Stone	8 8:45a Brighter Minds Music 9a Playgroup Brunch
9 6a Joy Catering 10a Rally Day Worship 3p Youth Group 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	10 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Bible Study 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p Finance 6:30p Harry Potter Adult Class	11 <i>Patriot Day 9/11</i> 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Church Council 6:30p Nokomis Prov.	12 5p Methodicals 6:45p Choir	13 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Scandalous Gospel of Jesus 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 2:30p BMM	14 10a Al-Anon 10:30a Brighter Minds 6:30p RCA 7p Fellowship Hall reserved	15 8:45a Brighter Minds Music 5p Game Night and Potluck
16 9a Worship with Organ 11a Worship with Band 3p Youth Group 7p SAA	17 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p Harry Potter Adult Class	18 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters 6:30p Worship Committee	19 5p Methodicals 5:30p Wednesday Dinner 6:45p Choir	20 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Scandalous Gospel of Jesus 2:30p BMM	21 <i>International Day of Peace</i> Newsletter items due 10a Al-Anon 10:30a Brighter Minds 6:30p RCA	22 7a MinneHarvest 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
23 <i>Fall Begins</i> 9a Worship with Organ 11a Worship with Band 3p Youth Group 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	24 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p Harry Potter Adult Class	25 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p SPR	26 5p Methodicals 5:30p Wednesday Dinner 6:45p Choir	27 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Scandalous Gospel of Jesus 2:30p BMM 6:30p Toastmasters 6:30p Trustees & B+G	28 9a Newsletter Collation 10a Al-Anon 10:30a Brighter Minds 6:30p RCA	29 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
30 9a Worship with Organ 10:15a Faith Forum: Current Issues Facing the World and the Church. 11a Worship with Band 3p Youth Group 7p SAA	Notes: Notes: <i>The calendar is accurate, to the best of our knowledge, at the time of printing. Dates and details may change at any time. Please visit www.minnehaha.org to view an up-to-date version of the calendar, and please contact Heather before scheduling any meetings or events. If they aren't on the calendar, you are not guaranteed a meeting space.</i>					

RELIEVE EDITORIAL STRESS:

**TURN IN
YOUR ARTICLES
EARLY!**

RE M I N D E R :

**DEADLINE FOR
NEWSLETTER
ARTICLES IS**

September 21

Worship in September

Harry Potter Film Series

We'll be watching each of the movies based on J.K. Rowling's Harry Potter series. See the schedule elsewhere for specifics, but we'll be watching a movie each week (in advance of the sermon on that book), and the movies will be shown either on Friday evening or Saturday morning.

9th	"Claimed"	Psalm 139:1-4, 7-16
	<i>One Service, outside at 10:00.</i>	
16th	"Choosing"	Joshua 24:14-15
23rd	"Good and Evil"	Genesis 2:4b-9, 15-17
30th	"What You Believe Matters"	Luke 17:5-6

Save the Date

Future special events at Minnehaha UMC:

- Oct. 7 – World Communion Sunday
- Oct. 12 – Monthly Taizé services begin
- Oct. 27 – Harvest Dinner
- Nov. 4 – All Saints Day
- Nov. 10 – Bazaar
- Nov. 21 – Ecumenical Thanksgiving Eve Service
- Dec. 1 – Advent Party
- Dec. 14 – Blue Christmas Taizé
- Dec. 16 – Christmas Pageant
- Dec. 24 – Christmas Eve services at 4:00 & 10:00
- Dec. 30 – One service at 10:00



What: Faith Formation Preschool Open House
When: Wednesday, 29th August; 5:30-7pm
Where: Preschool Room (rm. 202) at Minnehaha
Who: All Families with Preschool Age (3 & 4 year olds) Children for the 2018-2019 Program Year
What: A chance to visit the Sunday School space and to learn about our Faith Formation programs.

At Minnehaha, we strive to help children develop curiosity about their faith, and to give them opportunities to seek, serve, and celebrate God's love in an intergenerational and inclusive setting.

Minnehaha United Methodist Church
 3701 E. 50th Street, Minneapolis 55417
www.minnehaha.org, 612.721.6231
 Questions? Contact Jenia Strom, Director of Children & Family Ministries at education@minnehaha.org



Minnehaha Playgroup

For Children 5 and Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9:30-11:30am

Stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

hosted by
Minnehaha United Methodist Church

When weather permits, we gather at local parks for playgroup. Otherwise, we meet at Minnehaha UMC, in the Childcare Room. If you'd like to join us on any given week, and want to know where to find us: join the "Minnehaha Playgroup" Facebook Page for weekly updates.

3701 E. 50th Street, Minneapolis 55417

education@minnehaha.org

612.721.6231

Minnehaha Children, Youth, and Family Ministries

Interim Director Announcement

Jenia will be assuming the role of Interim Director for Children, Youth and Families through the 2018-2019 Program year (*see full article pg. 7*). Her role with the youth will be a bit of a departure from the previous Youth Director, in that she will be in charge of overall program development and leadership by coordinating with Adult volunteers to run many of the events and programs. We will be seeking to have a consistent group of core volunteers to build and foster meaningful relationships and connections with our youth. Jenia, Matt Zimmerman (*chair of the Staff-Parish Relations Committee*) and I, along with Youth Council and SPR will be working to clarify the role. We look forward to your help and support as we transition our leadership. I am looking forward to a great year for our youth program.

Thanks,
Jason Emrick
Youth Council Chair



I am always so excited for summer's arrival, to depart from regular routines, to live outside a bit more. I am equally excited to say goodbye to summer, I am ready for routines to return and for autumnal blue skies. I always love the color of leaves changing, the smell of pumpkins, visiting apple orchards, and even back-to-school shopping. But, for me the most comforting part of fall is that return to routine. Having a predictable rhythm to our days offers security. And, as you do when a "new year" begins, I find myself considering how we want to being this (school) year anew.

(Continued on page 5)

Minnehaha Children & Family Ministries Weekly Offerings Beginning September 16th:

Sundays:

Worship at 9am & 11am, with childcare provided from 8:45am-noon.

Children are always welcome in worship in Minnehaha, but you are welcome to bring those five and under to our nursery, room 204.

Sunday School for preschoolers and older: 10:15am-11am in the Education Wing. For families with babies & toddlers, we offer quarterly Young Family Sunday School classes, and you are always welcome to connect, play, and sip coffee in our nursery space throughout the year.

Wednesdays:

NEW THIS YEAR, our Wednesday night dinner and programming will begin in September! Join us starting September 19th for a midweek meal together, programming and playtime will be available. Dinner will be served from **5:30 to 6:15pm**, and **programming will be from 6:15 to 7pm**. Watch for more details coming soon!

Thursdays:

Playgroup (for children 5 and under and their caregivers) happens each week from **9:30-11:30am** (note the time change). As long as we have good weather, we'll be continuing to explore neighborhood parks. As fall progresses, we'll move inside to rooms 202 and 204.

We hope you'll make these part of your routine!
Please contact Jenia Strom at education@minnehaha.org if you have any questions.

Minnehaha Youth Kick-Off Our 2018-2019 Schedule on September 16th!

Sunday Mornings: Sunday School from 10:15am-11:00am,
Worship at 9 or 11am

Sunday Afternoons: Youth Group and Confirmation from 3-4:30pm

Wednesday Evenings: Midweek Youth Group from 6:15-7pm, All-Church
Dinners at 5:30pm

This year, starting September 19th, we'll be offering youth midweek programming on Wednesday evenings. This will be for combined 6th-12th graders and we'll be mixing up what we do each week. To start us off on the 19th, we invite youth to bring their bicycles to church, and Terry Eichten will be doing a crash course in bicycle maintenance. Sunday evenings will continue as in the past, with programming for our Middle Schoolers and confirmands three weeks a month, and a combined youth group (6th-12th) gathering once a month. Beth & Paul Minehart will be working with 10th-12th graders based on their schedules.

THE PARENT MEETING HAS BEEN PUSHED BACK TO SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 16th from 3-4:30pm. Childcare will be available.

Please stay tuned for more information.

THERE WILL BE NO YOUTH GROUP OR PARENT MEETING ON RALLY DAY, September 9th.

Finally, don't forget to register for the 2018-2019 Program Year. A link to registration was emailed to you, and you can find it on the church website: www.minnehaha.org.

What do we want as part of our daily routines? What do we want in our weekly routines? How will we achieve that allusive balance? How will we make time for all the things we want to do? How will we make time for each other? What activities will invigorate us? What things will offer us renewal? What will offer time for connection?

We consider all of these things as a church family as well, and so, as a new program year begins, we consider how we balance all that we do. What are we doing to seek, serve, and celebrate? What are we doing to bring God's transforming love to the world? What are we doing to be a sanctuary - a place where all feel welcome and safe and are blessed?

We hope that you will make Minnehaha a part of your routines this year, and that you will join with our community in opportunities to connect with one another and the world, that you will find this community one that renews, that you will find this a place where God's work is done.

Happy New Year,
Jenia Strom
*Interim Program Director of Children,
Youth, and Family Ministries*



Harry Potter and the Search for Meaning

We'll be focusing on the world of Harry Potter this fall with book studies, sermons, and films. We know that as the books progress through the series, the content gets darker. Some of you have worked hard to make sure that your children are reading content that is appropriate to their emotional maturity, so we wanted to give you a heads up about the series. The sermons will make references to significant events in each book, so there will be some spoilers for children who have not read the entire series yet. The sermons will be dealing with the meat of the books, but will not include gory details. However, reference to character's deaths will probably happen, as well as some of the eventual twists in the plot. Becky and Jenia are working to try to give options for children who want to be in worship, but don't want to hear spoilers as the series progresses. You can check in with either of them if you have specific concerns, and also check the Children's page in the newsletter to see what alternatives might be offered (for instance, for one of the weeks, the children's choir will have a quick practice during the sermon time).

Harry Potter

and the Search for Meaning

This Fall, join us for a seven-week series of sermons, book studies, and films as we explore the world of Harry Potter, and search for meaning one story at a time.

"It is our choices that show what we truly are." — Albus Dumbledore



HARRY POTTER & THE SORCERER'S STONE

Fri., Sept. 7: Film (7:00 p.m.)
Sun., Sept. 9: Sermon (one service at 10:00 a.m.)
Mon., Sept. 10: Adult Book Study (6:30 p.m.)
We'll explore what it means to be claimed.



HARRY POTTER & THE CHAMBER OF SECRETS

Fri., Sept. 14: Film (7:00 p.m.)
Sun., Sept. 16: Sermon (9:00 & 11:00 a.m.)
Mon., Sept. 17: Adult Book Study (6:30 p.m.)
We'll explore the role of choice.



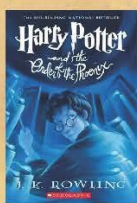
HARRY POTTER & THE PRISONER OF AZKABAN

Fri., Sept. 21: Film (7:00 p.m.)
Sun., Sept. 23: Sermon (9:00 & 11:00 a.m.)
Mon., Sept. 24: Adult Book Study (6:30 p.m.)
We'll explore the nuances of good and evil.



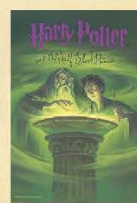
HARRY POTTER & THE GOBLET OF FIRE

Fri., Sept. 28: Film (7:00 p.m.)
Sun., Sept. 30: Sermon (9:00 & 11:00 a.m.)
Mon., Oct. 1: Adult Book Study (6:30 p.m.)
We'll explore how what you believe matters.



HARRY POTTER & THE ORDER OF THE PHOENIX

Fri., Oct. 5: Film (7:00 p.m.)
Sun., Oct. 7: Sermon (9:00 & 11:00 a.m.)
Mon., Oct. 8: Adult Book Study (6:30 p.m.)
We'll explore the importance of community in our lives.



HARRY POTTER & THE HALF-BLOOD PRINCE

Sat., Oct. 13: Film (9:00 a.m.)
Sun., Oct. 14: Sermon (9:00 & 11:00 a.m.)
Mon., Oct. 15: Adult Book Study (6:30 p.m.)
We'll explore the idea of destiny.



HARRY POTTER & THE DEATHLY HALLOWS

Fri., Oct. 19: Film: Part 1 (7:00 p.m.)
Sat., Oct. 20: Film: Part 2 (9:00 a.m.)
Sun., Oct. 21: Sermon (9:00 & 11:00 a.m.)
Mon., Oct. 22: Adult Book Study (6:30 p.m.)
We'll explore the theme of immortality.

On Saturday, October 27, we'll get together in celebration at our Hogwarts All-Hallows Eve Banquet, Dessert Auction and Concert. The party starts at 5:30 p.m. and ends at 9:00 p.m. Join us!



Minnehaha United Methodist Church
3701 East 50th Street, Mpls., MN 55417
www.minnehaha.org

Interim Director of Youth Program

The Staff -Parish Relations Committee has been listening carefully to families with youth, as well as assessing our congregations resources. We want to take this next year to continue to assess where we are and where we want to go without impeding the momentum we've been experiencing our youth program. To that end, we have asked Jenia Strom to be the Interim Director of the Youth Program for this program year. She will take this on in addition to her role as Director of Children & Families, and she will utilize the multiple volunteers we already have for the various facets of our youth program. The Youth Council will continue to meet and to plan and help implement some of our youth programming (like doing the meal for Rally Day), the youth will continue to meet weekly on Sunday afternoons, there will continue to be Sunday School for youth on Sunday mornings, and we will continue to offer a variety of other one-time youth events (like overnights, volunteering for MinneHarvest, etc.) throughout the year. As the year progresses, the Staff Parish Relations Committee will put together a job description, and we will look to hire a permanent Director of Youth & Families to be in place no later than one year from now.

We want to thank everyone who has been volunteering with youth, and to thank everyone who is stepping forward to volunteer for the next year. It is an amazing show of strength as we continue to develop the spiritual lives of our youth.

Staff-Parish Relations Committee: Stu Hazard, Pete Ketcham, Gail Minehart, Kim Neal, Chris Pow, Amy Retherford, Karl Talcott, Shirley Yeoman, Matt Zimmerman

Minnehaha Potluck and Game Night

Hosted by Todd & Tracy Gulliver

For MUMC adults of all ages

When: Saturday, September 15, from 5-9 pm

Where: Becketwood (4300 W. River Pkwy, Mpls)

Join us for food, fun and conversation at Minnehaha's monthly potluck. Bring a dish to share and your favorite game. We hope you can join us!

To RSVP, email Tracy Gulliver at tracygulliver@gmail.com or call 651-274-1657

"Second Service" Slide Projection

If you attend the second service (or first) on Sunday mornings, you know how nice it is to have the big screen up in front with all the words on it. This happens because we have had some pretty reliable members take charge. However, we are now looking for a couple more second service members to lighten the load. A calendar would be set up so that a second service attendee would only be responsible for one Sunday a month beginning September 16. If you are a techie person (or not) and are willing to learn the computer system to run the slides at second service, please call or text: Kim Kanuit at 612-860-0256.

Kim Kanuit, Worship Committee

First Friday Films

Do you find yourself shouting advice to characters during a movie? Nudging your neighbor with an elbow during critical scenes? Wishing you had someone to talk to about the movie you just watched? Then you are in luck! Come to the church on the first Friday of the month at 7:00 and settle in to watch a movie with fellow Minnehaha-ians. Bring your own beverage and snacks, and feel free to bring a friend as well. After the credits roll, you'll have an opportunity to share your "aha" moments, the things you liked or disliked, or anything else the movie prompted in you.

On Sept. 7 (7:00 in room 310) we'll be watching *Harry Potter and the Sorcerer's Stone*, the first in our weekly films based on the Harry Potter books by J.K. Rowling.

Minnehaha's Autumn Outdoor Adventure

Who: All Ages Welcome

When: Saturday, 29th September
3:30-6pm

Where: Lebanon Hills Park, Jensen Lake Trailhead

There's access to many hiking trails,
a great playground, and a canoe launch.

We'll gather to enjoy a beautiful autumn afternoon,
and encourage you to bring a picnic dinner along.

If weather doesn't cooperate, we'll reschedule.

This info will be on the website/FB Event.

One Service Sundays

We will be having one service on
two upcoming Sundays:

September 2 – one service inside
at 10:00. Labor Day
Weekend.

September 9 – one service
outside at 10:00 for our
program year kick-off.
There will be food for sale, a
bike parade, music, and
other fun events following
the service.

SAVE THE DATE: 'Will Party' Saturday, October 13 at 9:00 am

On Saturday, October 13, starting at 9:00 am with a continental breakfast, Minnehaha UMC will host another "Will Party" event. All are invited to attend, young and old.

The "Will Party" will provide an opportunity for those who wish to start or revise a will to meet with an attorney. Steve Otto of Otto Law (www.ottoesq.com), a Twin Cities law firm focusing on estate planning/probate administration and business law, will be at the meeting to talk about wills, answer your questions, and to meet one-on-one to discuss your estate planning needs. (There is no charge for this initial consultation.) If you would like to have a will drawn up or do other estate planning, you can set up a follow-up meeting.

Childcare will also be provided upon request. RSVP's not necessary but appreciated so we know about how many will be attending. Questions regarding this event and RSVP's may be directed to Kim Kanuit at 612-860-0256 (Call or Text).

Beechwood Benefit

Jim Shetler, long time member of MUMC, is hosting the following fundraising event and hopes to see you there.

2nd Annual BeechWood Benefit

Saturday, October 6, 2018

6-9:00 pm

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

Silent Auction, Mystery Boxes/Bags, Live Music, Appetizers and More

Tickets \$35 in advance and \$40 at the door

BeechWood provides quality in-home and community based services to low income individuals with disabilities (physical/mental/brain injury)—working with them to live independently and thrive in the community. Come join in the fun while showing your support and learning more about their services and staff.

For more information about BeechWood and to purchase tickets in advance, please visit www.beechwoodinc.org.

Adult Faith Forum Upcoming Topics

Everyone is welcome to join in our Faith Forum conversations this fall from 10:15-11 in the Fellowship Hall. From September 30-October 28 we'll learn about issues raised by the United Methodist Women at the world-wide General Assembly in May.

Sept. 30 - School to Prison Pipeline: how the mass incarceration in present day U.S. is affecting families of those in prison along with creating another generation of prisoners; what is being done and what can we do? - led by Geri and Ashley Cook

Oct. 7 - Spiritual Growth resources and themes from our international UMW organization To promote peace in the world around us, we must continually cultivate an inner peace. Discussion will focus on ways to sustain a sense of peace in our lives. - led by Tracy Gulliver

Oct. 14 - Global warming and its disproportional effect on communities of color and poverty. Unprecedented storms, drought, natural disasters and floods have taken an extreme toll on those already hurting. - led by Maureen Trepp

Oct. 21 - Living Our Principles, the Social Principles and Economic Justice: discussion on how the Social Principles can help us understand the root causes and effects of economic disparity and to consider ways we can respond on faith as communities. – led by Kim Kanuit

Oct. 28 - Understanding Palestine and Israel: What can be done to end the violence? - led by Shirley Arms and John Darlington

Funeral/Memorial Receptions

Minnehaha continues a tradition of providing a time for grieving families to visit with extended family and friends after funeral/memorial services. (Not all churches do this anymore.) Currently, we have a list of dedicated volunteers who help with receptions but more members are needed to fill in where we have gaps. The areas where help is always needed are:

Weekdays to prep food, serve, and cleanup

Weekends to prep food, serve, and cleanup

Evenings to prep food and set tables

Baking bars and desserts

Washing dishes

If you are willing to be added to any one or more of these volunteer lists, please call or text: Kim Kanuit at 612-860-0256 or Jan Hougen at 612-669-7408.

Solar Committee Update

We have had tremendous support from the MUMC community for solar energy! Thanks to those who supported the Solar Committee with their votes and also to those who put forth contributions to the cause. The final stages of financing are underway and solar panels have arrived! The Solar Committee continues to engage with our partners to ensure that the project moves forward smoothly, and we expect the system will be up and running no later than October 31st, 2018. We will be providing regular updates in the upcoming weeks as more visible signs of the solar installation project get underway. Questions can be emailed to Chris Kramer at chriskramerpt@gmail.com.

The Solar Committee is excited to see Minnehaha move into a future of greater environmental stewardship!

July 2018 Solar Project Dashboard

 Green	Scope
 Green	Schedule
 Green	Budget

Communion at Nokomis Square

A brief service of communion is offered at Nokomis Square on the second Thursday of this month. All are welcome to join us on September 13 at 1:00 p.m.

MinneHarvest

One out of six Minnesotans goes hungry on a regular basis. Our free food give-away once a month is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. Please join us this month on Saturday, September 22. You can volunteer anytime between 7:00 and 10:30 a.m. We unload the trucks starting at 7, serve the food at 9:00, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30. Join us, and bring a friend!

Fall Adult Classes

This fall, there will be two adult classes offered during the week.

Harry Potter – Monday evenings, 6:30-8:00 Sept. 10 – Oct. 22

In conjunction with the sermon series, we'll read each of the books in the Harry Potter series, discussing their contents and the themes from the sermon the day before. If it's been awhile since you last read this series, you may want to re-acclimate yourself with them, and if you haven't read them before, you may want to start now since some of the books are quite long.

The Scandalous Gospel of Jesus – Thursday mornings, 10-11:30 Sept. 13 – Nov. 29

The late Peter Gomes was a professor, author, and longtime chaplain of the Harvard Memorial Chapel. In *The Scandalous Gospel*, he takes the church to task for focusing more on doctrines and rigid teachings than what Jesus actually had to say. The book is focused on helping the reader to encounter Jesus more directly, and ascertain what Jesus would have me do today. The book can be found online through Cokesbury (or Amazon), or can be easily ordered through your favorite bookstore. We'll start with chapter 1 on Sept. 13.

Food Ministries

MUMC financially supports **two food ministries**. MinneHarvest is a monthly free food giveaway, and our Food Shelf is a weekly food shelf for residents in our neighborhood, supported by us, Lake Nokomis Lutheran, and St. James Episcopal on the Parkway. Both of these ministries need regular financial support in order for them to continue to provide food to those in need. Please consider making a regular contribution to one or both of these ministries; you can use the handy envelopes provided in the pews, or you can write a check and indicate either MinneHarvest or Food Shelf on the memo line.

If you would like to volunteer your time, the Food Shelf and MinneHarvest have plenty of spaces for volunteers. We can also use volunteers for our other two food ministries, Meals on Wheels and serving a meal at Simpson Housing Services. You can contact Becky to volunteer for Meals on Wheels, and Maureen Trepp for the next SHS meal date.

Children's Library

Did you know that we have an excellent Children's Library on the second floor stairway landing? It's chock full of religious, seasonal, learning, and just plain "fun" books for younger children to read. If you are a parent, grandparent, or friend of a child, I'm sure you have visited it already. If not, please do!

A couple things:

We have had many books loaned out this past year and some have not found their way back. Please check your bookshelves for books that need returning. September is a good time to bring them all back.

If you are a parent, grandparent, or friend of a child, you may be looking for something to do on Sunday morning when your children are in Sunday school. I am looking for several helpers to keep the library organized, put returned books back on the shelf, fix and repair broken books, etc. If you are willing to help, please call or text Kim Kanuit at 612-860-0256.

...and thank you to all the Moms who covered all the new books last year. That was a huge help!

Kim Kanuit, *Children's Library*



Harry Potter

When John Wesley (one of the founders of United Methodism) was gathering fellow Oxford students together to grow together spiritually, they agreed to a covenant. In that covenant, they set out how they wanted to behave, how often they would pray, etc. Although it was common at that time to encourage deeply religious folk to only read the Bible, John Wesley deviated from that. He told his group that he thought God's inspiration could be found in good literature as well as in the Bible. The Bible was still primary, but the group often read other works as well, talking together about how these texts pointed them to deeper understandings of God and humanity.

That's one of the things I like about United Methodism – we understand the importance of the Bible, but we don't assume that God only speaks in one place, or with one language, or to just one group of people. I have read plenty of books that provided not one spark of deeper meaning or insight, but I have read plenty of books that caused me to put them down for a moment and ponder the implications or truth of what I have just read. It means that I worship a living God, one whom is reaching out to me (and to others) in ways that are too myriad to pin down, and in ways that often surprise and delight me.

As we explore Harry Potter this fall, I invite you into the world of magic and wonder and teenage angst. Into a world of good and evil and things hard to define. Into a world of ghosts and goblins (literal ghosts and goblins) and children and adults, all trying to find their way. Join with others in deeper conversations and contemplations on how we might see God in different and unexpected ways.

In Joy,
Becky



WEDNESDAY NIGHTS AT MINNEHAHA BEGINNING SEPTEMBER 19TH

Each week, join us midweek
to connect with our Minnehaha Community.

All-Church Dinner: Served from 5:30 to 6:15pm,

Cost: \$5/person, \$20/family

Programming for Children: 6:15 to 7pm

Midweek Youth Group: 6:15 to 7pm

Adult Choir: 6:45-8pm

Interested in being a part of our hosting, cooking, clean-up crew? We'd love to have you! Contact Jenia Strom at education@minnehaha.org



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9/18



Minnehaha Rally Day 2018

9th September

Join with members of the Minnehaha United Methodist Church community as we celebrate the beginning of a new program year.

One Worship Service Outside at 10am, followed by:

- Meeting & Greeting Sunday School Teachers
- Celebrating the Installation of our Solar Panels
- Face painting, a bike parade, and lawn games
- All-Church Lunch, cost \$5/person

50th Street will be closed between 36th Ave and 37th Ave for the morning's festivities, please plan accordingly.